

Government Contracting

The government is the world's largest customer — and it's required to buy from small businesses. Below are the steps and resources to win contracts. Tick the box once you've done each one.

⚠ BEFORE YOU START

Selling to the government takes setup, but free advisors guide you the whole way. Certifications for women-, veteran-, minority-, and disadvantaged-owned firms give you a real edge.

1 Get Registered

You must register (free) before you can win any federal contract.

☐ Register on SAM.gov

Free, required registration to do business with the federal government.

→ sam.gov

☐ SBA — Contracting Guide

Step-by-step guide to becoming a government contractor.

→ www.sba.gov/federal-contracting/contracting-guide

2 Get Certified for an Edge

Set-aside programs reserve contracts for specific small businesses.

☐ 8(a), WOSB, VOSB & HUBZone Programs

Certifications for disadvantaged, women-, veteran-owned, and underserved-area businesses.

→ www.sba.gov/federal-contracting/contracting-assistance-programs

☐ HUBZone Program

Special help for businesses in historically underutilized areas.

→ www.sba.gov/federal-contracting/contracting-assistance-programs/hubzone-program

3 Get Free Expert Help

Specialists help small businesses win government work — free.

☐ APEX Accelerators (formerly PTACs)

Free, expert help finding and bidding on government contracts.

→ www.apexaccelerators.us

4 Find Opportunities

Where contracts are posted and how to start small.

☐ **SAM.gov — Contract Opportunities**

Search current federal contract opportunities.

→ sam.gov/content/opportunities

☐ **Subcontracting & State/Local**

Start by subcontracting with bigger firms, and check your state/city procurement sites too.

→ www.sba.gov/federal-contracting/contracting-guide/find-subcontracting-opportunities

⚠ **WATCH OUT FOR**

Registration on SAM.gov and APEX Accelerator help are FREE. Avoid companies charging large fees to “register” or “certify” you — the official processes cost nothing.

★ **A TIP THAT HELPS**

Connect with a free APEX Accelerator counselor before bidding. They’ll help you register correctly, get certified, and find realistic first contracts — saving months of trial and error.

NEED HELP WHERE YOU LIVE?

Need help where you live?

This guide covers national steps. For your nearest APEX Accelerator and state/local contract programs, use the personalized AI search or ask in the Questions area.

MY NOTES — WHO I CALLED, WHEN, AND WHAT THEY SAID
